

JACK SENECHAL

IT DIRECTOR · RELIABILITY, SECURITY & GOVERNANCE

Located in Novato, CA

Phone: 415-779-2701

Email: jacksenechal@gmail.com

GitHub: github.com/jacksenechal

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jacksenechal

SUMMARY

Technology leader with **6+ years leading engineering and platform organizations** whose platform every engineering team and the entire customer-facing product depended on. Runs secure, resilient operations, builds the governance and operating models that make technology a dependable partner to the rest of the organization, leads a small team through its own leads, and explains risk and cost to executives who want a decision rather than a technical answer.

- **Secure and resilient operations:** owned the shared infrastructure platform an entire engineering organization ran on, including security posture, access management, monitoring and alerting, on-call design, and disaster recovery, treated as standing practice rather than an annual project.
- **Governance and operating models:** established the policies, review gates, change control, and service practices that changed how an organization delivered, then carried them across teams as a change agent rather than by mandate.
- **Incident response and business continuity:** took an unreliable production platform to **~100x fewer errors and incidents**, ran incident response and postmortems, and moved an unstable production database onto a managed service, eliminating an entire class of outages.
- **Leading a team through its leads:** rebuilt a critical operations team from two engineers after mass departures with hiring, onboarding, documented practice, and a sustainable on-call rotation, and **grew multiple junior engineers into senior software engineer and engineering manager roles. Top Performer Award, 2021.**
- **Vendor management and cost discipline:** selects and consolidates platforms and vendors on cost, risk, and long-term maintainability, and retires hand-built systems that carry hidden operating cost.
- **Modernization without disruption:** led migrations of long-lived systems onto modern cloud platforms, including a **zero-downtime** cutover with no user-visible impact.
- **Responsible AI with governance:** co-founded a nonprofit publishing an open-source benchmark for responsible AI behavior, and builds AI-assisted systems where review, testing, and supply-chain controls are enforced by the system rather than left to good intentions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant · AI-Native Software Delivery

Client engagements | May 2026 - Present | Remote

Scope: designs the delivery process and governance model; holds the product and prioritization seat.

- Designs and runs **AI-assisted delivery pipelines** that carry engineering work from requirement to production, with a human accountable for scope, priority, and acceptance.
- **Governance built into the system:** every change passes an independent reviewer, automated testing, supply-chain security scanning, and a deployment verification step. The operating thesis, proven in practice, is that anything merely instructed rather than enforced will drift.
- Uses a single durable system of record for work intake, review, and status, with status **derived from verifiable reality** rather than maintained by hand in a tracker nobody trusts.
- Practical view of where AI adoption pays off and where it does not, grounded in running it daily rather than in vendor claims.

Co-founder & Fractional CTO

Building Humane Technology | June 2025 - Present | Remote (part-time)

Scope: technical direction and roadmap for a nonprofit engineering team; advises rather than implements.

- **Originated and co-architected HumaneBench.ai**, an open-source framework for evaluating whether AI systems behave in the public interest, covering transparency, privacy, and user wellbeing.

- Serves as **fractional CTO** to the team that built it into a published, externally used product, shaping architecture, evaluation design, and technical direction.
- Designed and specified a **real-time evaluation classifier** that scores AI behavior against those standards inline at **sub-100ms**, fast enough to sit in a live request path rather than run only after the fact.
- Owns technical product direction: operational visibility, evaluation feedback loops, and adoption maturity models organizations can actually follow.

Co-founder & Software Engineer

Alchemy Astrology (formerly Mirror Astrology) | Nov 2024 - Jul 2026 | Remote

Scope: co-founder; owned front-end and design delivery, including outside design contractors.

- Owned front-end and design delivery for a production consumer subscription service, and managed freelance designers through to shipped work.
- Collaborated on back-end delivery: payment processing, single sign-on authentication, and application architecture.
- Partnered with co-founders on product direction, roadmap, and prioritization.

Infrastructure Engineer

Tobiko | Mar 2024 - Oct 2024 | Remote

Scope: cloud platform serving production customer workloads.

- Architected and operated a cloud platform running production customer workloads, with reliability, security, and repeatability as the standard.
- Implemented infrastructure as code so environments were provisioned from reviewed, version-controlled definitions instead of by hand.
- Stood up a customer support and incident response workflow with defined response expectations, and onboarded staff and customers onto it.

Engineering Manager / Principal Software Engineer

Mavenlink / Kantata | Apr 2017 - Dec 2023 | San Francisco, CA

Scope: led two engineering teams over seven years, including the shared infrastructure platform relied on by every engineering team in the company. Partnered with product, security, and application groups on standards adopted organization-wide.

- **Infrastructure Platform and DevOps** (4 years): Took over a team reduced to two engineers by mass departures and rebuilt it: recruiting, onboarding, documented practice, and an on-call rotation the team could sustain. Led the organization's engineering-practice transformation as a change agent and technical authority across the company, setting standards other teams adopted because they worked, not because they were mandated. Owned roadmap, intake and triage of requests from every engineering team, and priority tradeoffs among them.
- **Legacy modernization:** Moved a long-lived codebase and its server estate onto modern cloud-native, infrastructure-as-code tooling, replacing hand-built systems with reproducible, auditable configuration. Led the migration of the core application and its surrounding services onto a modern container platform, and moved an unstable production database onto a managed service, eliminating an entire class of outages. Migration decisions were made on scale, cost, and consistency grounds.
- **Enterprise integrations turnaround** (2 years): Led the team that stabilized and scaled the platform connecting the company's product to customers' CRM, HR, and accounting systems. Established the operational metrics, monitoring, and alerting that took it from frequent business-visible failures to **~100x fewer errors and incidents**, then executed a **zero-downtime migration** onto the modern platform with no customer impact.
- **Reliability and sustainable operations:** Drove a sustained push that dramatically reduced after-hours incident volume, which in turn produced strong retention and good working relationships across the engineering organization.
- **Developing people:** Grew multiple junior engineers into senior software engineer and engineering manager roles, and mentored engineers across teams. Led interviewing and hiring. **Top Performer Award, 2021.**

Lead Developer, Co-founder

Pegg | 2014 - 2017 | San Francisco, CA

- Co-founded and led development of a cross-platform mobile product from scratch.
- Established the engineering workflow the team ran on: peer review, automated testing, and continuous delivery.
- Co-led product strategy, monetization, and launch planning.

Earlier Career (2001 - 2014)

- **Consultant & Entrepreneur** (2008 - 2014): Founded an automated-testing education venture. Delivered custom systems for commercial clients, including an e-commerce ordering platform for an established retailer. Full-stack consulting and rapid delivery.

- **Web Developer, OnForce, Inc** (2006 - 2007): Introduced automated testing and continuous integration. Integrated the platform with third-party enterprise systems.
- **Development Lead, JBA Network** (2003 - 2006): Lead programmer and project manager for a commercial software product. Architected the initial release, then built and scaled the development team.

LEADERSHIP PRACTICE

- **Security and risk:** access management, change control, dependency and supply-chain scanning, security review built into the delivery path, vulnerability identification and remediation.
- **Operations and service delivery:** monitoring and alerting, incident response and postmortems, on-call design, support and escalation workflows with response commitments, business continuity and disaster recovery.
- **Governance and standards:** policy, review gates, change control, and documented practice, set centrally and adopted willingly because they reduce work rather than add it. Preparing materials and running the decision forums where technology priorities get set.
- **Vendor and cost discipline:** platform and vendor selection and contracting on cost, risk, and long-term maintainability; consolidation onto shared and managed services where it lowers total cost of ownership; operating and capital budget planning with executive partners.
- **Strategy and roadmap:** multi-year technology planning, investment sequencing, business-case framing, portfolio and prioritization tradeoffs across competing departments.
- **Modernization and integration:** legacy system replacement, cloud migration, system-to-system integration and data flow between business systems, phased cutover planning, zero-downtime delivery.
- **People:** hiring and team building, coaching, delegation through team leads, succession through growing individual contributors into senior and management roles, cross-functional partnership, change management.
- **Communication:** translating technical risk and tradeoffs into terms non-technical stakeholders can decide on.
- **Technical depth:** cloud platforms (AWS, Google Cloud), Kubernetes and containers, infrastructure as code (Terraform, Ansible), CI/CD, relational and document databases, API and systems integration architecture, AI and LLM systems, collaboration platforms (Google Workspace, Slack).

EDUCATION

BA in Mathematics, minor in Computer Science

University of North Carolina at Asheville | May 2003

- Graduated with distinction in Mathematics.

SELECTED OPEN SOURCE

- **HumaneBench:** open-source framework for evaluating human-friendly behavior in AI assistants, covering transparency, privacy, and wellbeing.
- **Scan MCP:** privacy-first document digitization tooling.

RECOMMENDATIONS

“Jack has **had quite a profound impact on my career**. As a young engineer, I was fortunate enough to work with Jack as my coach. He served as a great mentor, helping me build both technical and professional skills. **His mentorship was a key factor in elevating me from an incoming Junior Engineer to an Engineering Manager.**”

— Wesley Morlock, *Engineering Manager, Kantata*

“Jack is **an exceptional engineer and leader**. He strives to **deeply understand the technology** he’s working on while remaining cognizant of the socio-technical components that may be a factor in any project. He does all this with a **strong team mentality**, and can **effectively delegate to help lift others’ skill sets.**”

— Brandon Clifford, *Director of DevOps, Kantata*

See additional recommendations on LinkedIn